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ShopSmart Electronics — Product Troubleshooting & Care Guide

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> Support agents should work through the relevant troubleshooting steps before issuing a Return Merchandise Authorization. Many reported "defects" resolve with a reset or firmware update, and an unnecessary return costs the customer 7–14 days of waiting.

1. When to Troubleshoot vs. When to Return

Situation	Action
Item does not power on at all, out of the box, within 48 hours of delivery	Dead-on-Arrival — no troubleshooting required, immediate replacement or refund
Physical damage visible on arrival	Damaged-in-transit claim — photograph and report within 48 hours
Wrong item received	Immediate free return and correct item shipped expedited
Intermittent fault, connectivity issue, software behaviour	Troubleshoot first — see sections below
Fault appears after more than 48 hours but within the return window	Troubleshoot first; if unresolved, standard return applies
Fault appears after the return window but within warranty	Troubleshoot first; if unresolved, warranty claim applies

Time spent troubleshooting does not extend the return window. If a customer is near the end of their window, initiate the return first and troubleshoot in parallel.

2. Audio & Headphones

2.1 One earbud not working

1. Place both earbuds in the charging case and confirm both show a charging indicator
2. Clean the charging contacts on both the earbud and the case with a dry cotton swab
3. Forget the device in the phone's Bluetooth settings, then re-pair from scratch
4. Perform a factory reset: hold both earbuds' touch sensors for 15 seconds while in the open case
5. If the earbud still does not charge or pair, the fault is hardware — proceed with return or warranty claim

2.2 Noise cancellation not working or weak

Active noise cancellation degrades when ear tips do not seal properly. Confirm the customer is using the correct tip size — most models ship with three sizes. Check the microphone mesh for blockage from earwax or debris. Run the companion app's fit test where available. ANC also weakens significantly at low battery; charge above 20% before testing.

2.3 Audio cutting out or stuttering

Bluetooth interference from Wi-Fi routers, microwaves and crowded 2.4 GHz environments is the most common cause. Test in a different location. Reduce the distance to the source device to under 3 metres with no obstructions. Disable nearby Bluetooth devices competing for bandwidth. Update firmware through the companion app — stuttering fixes are among the most common firmware updates shipped.

2.4 Battery draining faster than advertised

Advertised battery life assumes 50% volume with ANC off. With ANC enabled and volume above 70%, expect roughly 60% of the rated figure. Battery capacity below **80% of original** within the warranty period qualifies as battery degradation and is covered under ShopSmart Protect Plus, though not under Protect Basic or the Standard Warranty.

3. Laptops & Computers

3.1 Device will not power on

1. Connect the original charger and leave it for 30 minutes — a deeply discharged battery may show no indicator initially
2. Confirm the charger LED illuminates; test the wall outlet with another device
3. Perform a hard reset: hold the power button for 30 seconds with the charger disconnected
4. For removable-battery models, remove the battery, hold power for 30 seconds, reinstall
5. Listen for fan spin or drive activity; a completely silent machine with a working charger indicates a hardware fault

3.2 Slow performance after setup

New machines run background indexing, update downloads and antivirus scans for the first 24–48 hours. Advise the customer to leave the machine powered and connected for a full day before evaluating performance. Check for pending operating system updates and pre-installed trial software consuming resources.

3.3 Screen flickering or artifacts

Connect an external monitor. If the external display is clean, the fault is in the panel or its cable — a hardware return. If artifacts appear on the external display too, the fault is in the graphics hardware or driver. Roll back or update the graphics driver before concluding it is hardware.

3.4 Overheating and fan noise

Confirm the vents are not obstructed and the machine is on a hard surface, not fabric. Check running processes for a runaway task. Sustained temperatures causing shutdown under normal workloads indicate a cooling fault covered by warranty. Dust accumulation after extended use is normal wear, not a covered defect.

4. Televisions & Monitors

4.1 No picture, backlight visible

Cycle through all input sources with the TV remote rather than a universal remote. Test with a different HDMI cable and a different port — HDMI cable failure is extremely common and cables sold separately are consumables, not covered. Confirm the source device outputs at a resolution the panel supports.

4.2 Dead pixels

Industry standard tolerates a small number of stuck or dead pixels before a panel is considered defective. ShopSmart applies the following threshold:

Panel Size	Bright (stuck) pixels	Dark (dead) pixels	Total
Under 32 inches	2	3	4
32–55 inches	3	5	6
Over 55 inches	4	6	8

Panels exceeding these counts qualify as defective and are returnable or replaceable under warranty regardless of the standard return window. Panels within these counts are not defective; however, a customer may still return within the standard window as a normal change-of-mind return, subject to restocking fees where applicable.

4.3 Burn-in and image retention

Temporary image retention on OLED panels usually clears with the built-in pixel refresh cycle run overnight. Permanent burn-in from static content is classified as misuse and is **not** covered under the Standard Warranty or ShopSmart Protect. Advise customers to enable screen shift and logo dimming features.

5. Smartphones & Tablets

5.1 Device not charging

Inspect the charging port under light for lint — this causes the majority of reported charging failures and is resolved by careful cleaning with a wooden toothpick. Test a different cable and adapter. Confirm the adapter meets the device's wattage requirement; a low-wattage adapter may show "charging" but lose ground under load.

5.2 Rapid battery drain

Check battery health in system settings. Review the battery usage breakdown for a misbehaving app. Perform a restart, then evaluate over 24 hours. Battery health below 80% within the warranty period is a covered defect;

above 80% is considered normal degradation.

5.3 Device overheating during charging

Warmth during fast charging is normal. Heat sufficient to trigger a thermal warning, or a device too hot to hold, indicates a fault. Advise the customer to stop using the device, disconnect the charger, and contact support immediately. **Do not advise the customer to continue using a device showing swelling of the battery or case** — this is a safety hazard requiring immediate return with special handling instructions.

6. Smart Home Devices

6.1 Device will not connect to Wi-Fi

Most smart home devices support 2.4 GHz networks only. On combined-band routers broadcasting one SSID, temporarily separate the bands or use the router's guest 2.4 GHz network during setup. Confirm the password contains no characters the device's setup app cannot accept. Move the device within 3 metres of the router for initial pairing, then relocate.

6.2 Device drops offline repeatedly

Check Wi-Fi signal strength at the device's permanent location. Assign a static DHCP reservation in the router to prevent address conflicts. Confirm the router is not at its device limit — budget routers often cap around 32 concurrent devices. Repeated dropout with strong signal and no router limit indicates a hardware fault.

6.3 Voice assistant not responding

Verify the microphone mute switch is off — this is the single most common cause. Check the companion app for a pending firmware update. Re-run voice training where supported. Confirm the account linked to the device is still authenticated.

7. General Care Guidance

7.1 What counts as normal wear vs. covered defect

Condition	Classification
Scratches, scuffs and cosmetic marks	Normal wear — not covered
Battery above 80% health	Normal degradation — not covered
Battery below 80% health within warranty	Covered defect (Protect Plus covers; Standard Warranty covers factory defects only)
Worn ear cushions, stylus tips, cable fraying at connector	Consumable — not covered
Port failure with no visible physical damage	Covered defect
Liquid damage indicator triggered	Accidental damage — covered only under ShopSmart Protect Plus

Condition	Classification
Cracked screen from a drop	Accidental damage — covered only under ShopSmart Protect Plus
Dust accumulation causing thermal throttling	Maintenance — not covered

7.2 Preserving warranty eligibility

Advise customers to retain original packaging for the duration of the return window, avoid removing serial number labels, use only manufacturer-approved chargers and accessories, and refrain from opening the device case. Each of these actions can void warranty coverage as described in the Warranty Terms.

8. Escalation

Escalate to Tier 2 support when: the customer reports a safety issue such as swelling, smoke or burning smell; the same fault recurs on a replacement unit; the fault affects a product under an active Protect Plus claim; or the customer disputes a defect determination. Safety issues are escalated immediately and the customer is advised to stop using the product.

- **Technical Support:** 1-800-746-7762, option 5
- **Email:** techsupport@shopsmartelectronics.com
- **Hours:** Monday – Saturday, 8:00 AM – 10:00 PM EST; Sunday 10:00 AM – 8:00 PM EST